BIOLOGICAL/PHYSICAL FALSE BELIEF #74 · SERVING GOD WITH LIMITS

“I have nothing left to give.”

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Where it often comes from

Long illness, caregiving, or chronic fatigue can leave us depleted. With no energy to give, we may feel empty and ashamed.

What Scripture teaches

Peter said to the lame man, “Silver or gold I do not have, but what I have I give you.” We always have something. Jesus said, “Come to Me, all you who are weary and burdened, and I will give you rest.” You may need to receive before you give. “Cast your burden upon the LORD and He will sustain you.” Rest is not failure. In due time you will have more to share, and meanwhile your presence, prayers, and gratitude bless others.

> *“But Peter said, ‘Silver or gold I do not have, but what I have I give you: In the name of Jesus Christ of Nazareth, get up and walk!’”* (Acts 3:6).

Also see

> “Come to Me, all you who are weary and burdened, and I will give you rest” (Matthew 11:28).
>
> “Cast your burden upon the LORD and He will sustain you; He will never let the righteous be shaken” (Psalm 55:22).
>
> “He gives power to the faint and increases the strength of the weak” (Isaiah 40:29).
>
> “Let us not grow weary in well-doing, for in due time we will reap a harvest if we do not give up” (Galatians 6:9).

Common self-statements

- I am empty.
- I cannot help anyone.
- I have no energy.
- I am a taker.
- I have nothing to offer.
- Everyone gives more than I do.

Common logical errors

- All-or-nothing thinking: Believing I am either giving fully or giving nothing.
- Fortune telling: Predicting that I will always be empty.
- Emotional reasoning: Feeling depleted and concluding that I have nothing.
- Labeling: Calling myself empty.

Challenging questions

- What do I still have: time, prayers, listening, thanks?
- Whom could I bless in a small way?
- What do I need to receive first?
- Who might want to give to me?
- What does Scripture say about rest and strength?

- What is one small thing I can give?

Truth summary

> I may be depleted, but I am not empty-handed. I can receive rest and care from God and others, and give small things as strength allows. My presence and prayers matter.

Related Pearls topics

Click a topic to open it in the Pearls Scripture Search:

- Tired
- Weakness
- Humility
- Suffering
- Love, For Others

Godly Counsel Lessons:

From the book *Godly Counsel* by Dr. Brian Campbell. Click a lesson to open it. You can read it on screen or print it.

- Self-Esteem, Low
- Divorce

Listen: Overcoming Depression

> Overcoming Depression · Dr. Brian Campbell · about 20 minutes

Songs that speak truth to this belief

Just Be Held — Casting Crowns
God's care remains when control, strength, or explanations run out.

Praise You in This Storm — Casting Crowns featuring Phil Wickham
Suffering and tears do not establish that God is absent or uncaring.

Living Hope — Phil Wickham
Christ's resurrection and forgiveness provide hope beyond sin and death.

Blessed Assurance — Larry Ford and Lillie Knauls with Gaither
This classic hymn celebrates belonging to Christ and resting in His salvation.

Each morning ask: "If I truly believed God's truth instead of this lie, how would I think, speak, and act today?"

HOMEWORK · REPLACE AND REHEARSE

My Plan for Replacing "I have nothing left to give"

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Read through each section and check the one that fits you best. If none of them fit, write your own. One choice per section is enough. A truth you choose for yourself will stick better than one handed to you.

Name: _____ Date started: _____

1 How strongly do I believe the lie?

Rate it now so you can see your progress later.

"I have nothing left to give." I believe this _____ % (0 = not at all, 100 = completely)

2 My best question

The one question I will ask myself every time the lie shows up.

- ☐ What do I still have: time, prayers, listening, thanks?
- ☐ Whom could I bless in a small way?
- ☐ What do I need to receive first?
- ☐ Who might want to give to me?
- ☐ What does Scripture say about rest and strength?
- ☐ What is one small thing I can give?

My own question: _____

3 My replacement truth

The statement I will say to myself instead of the lie.

- ☐ What I have, I give.
- ☐ Jesus gives rest to the weary.
- ☐ The Lord sustains me.
- ☐ He gives power to the faint.
- ☐ Receiving is part of the cycle.
- ☐ Small gifts count.

In my own words: _____

4 My Scripture

The verse that speaks most directly to me. This is the one I will memorize.

- ☐ Acts 3:6
  "But Peter said, 'Silver or gold I do not have, but what I have I give you: In the name of Jesus Christ of Nazareth, get up and walk!'"
- ☐ Matthew 11:28
  "Come to Me, all you who are weary and burdened, and I will give you rest."
- ☐ Psalm 55:22
  "Cast your burden upon the LORD and He will sustain you; He will never let the righteous be shaken."

A verse I found myself: _____

_____

Practicing the Truth

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5 My practice plan

Everyone does the first four. Then pick one or two extra tools.

EVERYONE DOES THESE

- [ ] Make my Truth Card (below). Carry it and read it at least three times a day.
- [ ] Memorize my Scripture from Step 4.
- [ ] Listen to one song each day from "Songs that speak truth to this belief" on my card, and fill in my song journal (below).
- [ ] Set reminders to silently repeat my truth. Check one or more:
  - ☐ A buzz: my watch or phone vibrates every _____ minutes
  - ☐ An everyday event: every time I _____
  - ☐ A visual reminder: something I will see often, such as a sticky note on my mirror, my truth as the background picture on my phone, or a note on my car dashboard.

PICK ONE OR TWO THAT FIT ME

- [ ] Receiving and giving: Each week, note one thing you received and one you gave.
- [ ] My name in Scripture: Write a personal reminder based on my verse and read it aloud. Keep this application separate from the Bible quotation.

  For example, Acts 3:6 becomes: "Sarah can write: "Jesus gives rest to the weary.""
- [ ] Gratitude journal: Each night, write three things I thank God for.
- [ ] Truth recording: Record my own voice reading my Truth Card and verse, and listen in the car or on a walk.
- [ ] Reading: The "Tired" topic in Pearls.
- [ ] Listening: The Overcoming Depression audio by Dr. Brian Campbell. Tap to play.

6 My action step this week

Do one thing that tests the lie in real life.

These cards support emotional and spiritual care and do not replace medical care. Follow your doctor's advice about treatment and medication, and choose steps that are safe for your body. In an emergency call 911; for thoughts of self-harm call or text 988 (U.S.).

- [ ] Rest. Schedule real rest.
- [ ] Receive. Accept help and kindness.
- [ ] Give small. Send a note or pray.
- [ ] Read Isaiah 40:29. Ask for strength.

What I will do: _____

When: _____

What the lie predicts will happen: _____

7 End-of-week check-in

Bring this page to your next session.

What actually happened: _____

_____

What I learned: _____

The lie "I have nothing left to give": _____ % My truth: _____ %

Daily practice tracker

Day	Read my card	Said my verse	Used my reminder	Receiving and giving
Mon				
Tue				
Wed				
Thu				
Fri				
Sat				
Sun				

My song journal

After each day's song, write what it told you that challenges the lie.

Day	Song I listened to	What it told me that challenges the lie
Mon		
Tue		
Wed		
Thu		
Fri		
Sat		
Sun		

My Truth Card

THE LIE

~~I have nothing left to give.~~

THE TRUTH

GOD'S WORD

Copy onto a 3×5 card, or cut along the dashed line and carry it with you.

Prayer

Lord, I am empty. Restore me, give me strength, and let me give what I can. Amen.

Scripture quotations are from the Berean Standard Bible (BSB), which is in the public domain.